Gmail

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The Still Point of the turning world

1 message

Beyond The Bend Yoga <laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca> Mon, Jan 26, 2026 at 1:06 PM
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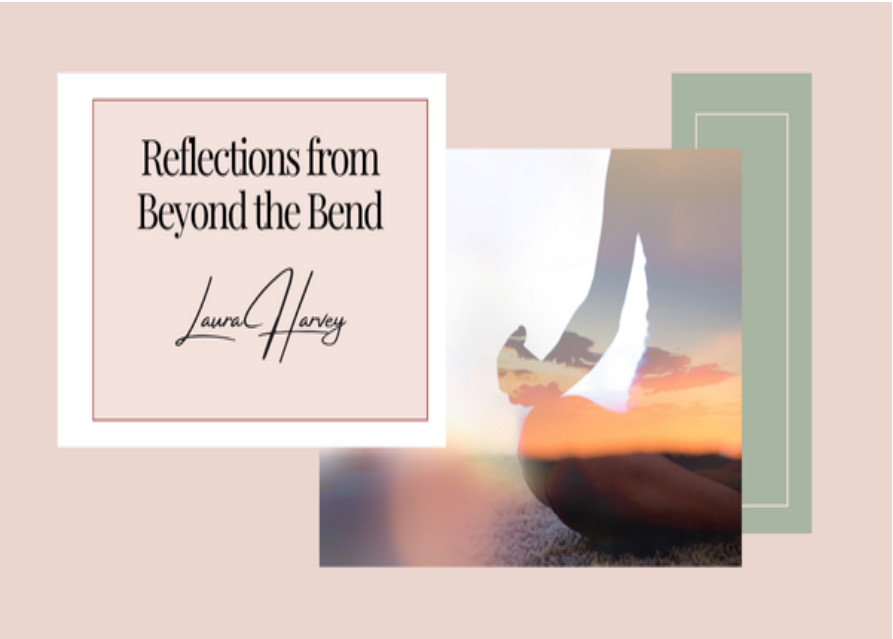
BEYOND THE BEND YOGA



Hello Laura

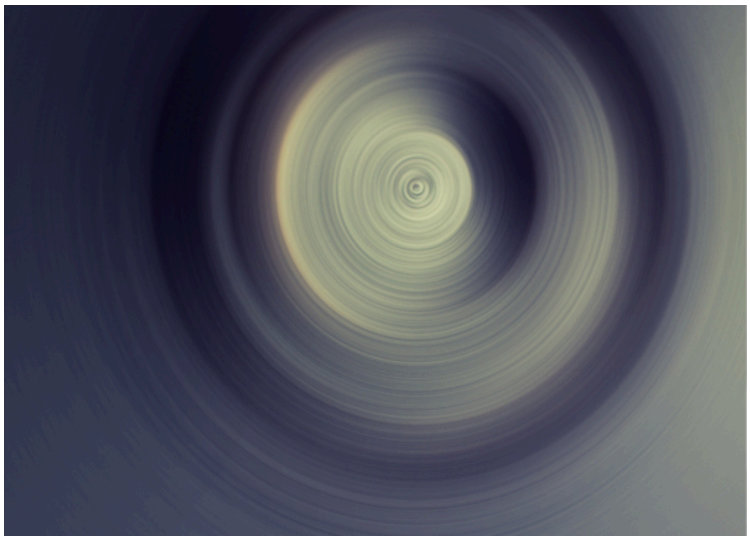
I've been sitting with a specific image all week, and I'm not entirely sure how to unpack it perfectly, but it feels important to share with you.

I've been reading about the poet T.S. Eliot. He spent his life trying to understand how we find peace in a chaotic world, and he wrote about a concept that won't let me go: ***"The Still Point of the turning world."***

It feels like he is describing exactly what we are living through right now. I hope that you come for some exploration with me this week.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura ❤️

This Week's Wellness Wisdom



The Turning World, The Still Point, and You

By Laura Harvey | Beyond the Bend Yoga

The Wheel

I notice this tension in my own life. It feels like living on the edge of a giant, spinning wheel. There's the to do list, the caretaking, the business of living, the schedules, the noise. That outer edge (let's call it **The Rim**) spins incredibly fast.

And I notice that when I live entirely on the Rim, I get dizzy. I feel scattered. I catch myself thinking that if I just spin a little faster, or manage the systems a little better, I'll finally catch up and find some peace.

But the spinning never really stops, does it?

Here's the thing I've been grappling with: None of that is *wrong*. The wheel has to turn. The laundry needs doing; the work needs tending. We can't just step off the world.

But if you look at a wheel, there's another part. **The Hub**. The Hub is the axle in the center. It carries all the weight. It allows the movement to happen. But the Hub itself? It doesn't spin.

Moving Your Seat

I'm realizing that my practice (and what I hope to offer you) isn't about trying to stop the wheel of your life. It's simply about **moving your seat**.

It's about shifting your attention from the exhausted, dizzying Rim back toward the Hub.

When we practice together, we aren't trying to "fix" the chaos or become more efficient at spinning. We're simply remembering that there's a place inside you (your breath, your spine, your deep "self") that *is* the Still Point.

It's the place that moves, but does not spin.

This isn't a one time arrival. It's a practice of returning. Again and again. Some days we find ourselves flung back out to the Rim, caught up in urgency, overwhelm, or the hundred small emergencies of daily life. And that's okay. The Hub is always there, waiting.

The body knows how to find it. The breath knows the way back.

What This Looks Like in Practice

For some women, the Still Point shows up in a long held restorative pose, where the nervous system finally exhales and says, *"Oh. I'm safe."*

For others, it's the moment in meditation when the mental chatter softens and you realize you've been watching your thoughts instead of becoming them.

And sometimes, it's as simple as noticing your feet on the ground and remembering: *I am here. I am whole. I don't have to spin.*

I don't have tidy answers on how to stay there permanently. The world is loud, and the pull of the Rim is strong. But I do know that when we soften the belly and find our breath, we protect a little space for that stillness to land.

We practice not to be perfect at stillness, but to become fluent in the language of return.

The Invitation (In Real Time)

As we move into this season, this is the work I'm most interested in doing.

My classes right now are focused on this shift using somatic movement and restorative rest to help us climb down from the dizziness of the day and find that "axis" in the body.

I still have space in my upcoming session (both here in Sherwood Park and online).

If this idea of "The Still Point" resonates with you, or if you know a friend who has been feeling particularly "dizzy" lately and needs a safe place to land, I'd be genuinely grateful if you passed this along.

Most of our community finds each other through word of mouth, someone saying, *"I think you might need this."* It tells me we're building something real.

Our Fall Session Has Begun – Drop-Ins Welcome

The session is underway, and we'd love for you to join us. Come experience the practice, feel the energy of the space, and see if it's the right fit for you.

Drop-In Details

$20 per class
Payment: Cash or e-transfer at the door
Easy online booking now available on the website

After your drop-in, if you'd like to continue with the full session, simply chat with me in class or send an email to laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca. We offer prorated pricing for those joining mid-way, which reduces your per-class cost.

Current Class Availability

Monday Evening – Somatic Vinyasa (6:00–7:15 PM)

Space available
A mindful flow practice that invites you to move with awareness and breath. If

you're looking for grounded movement to ease into your week, this class welcomes you.

Tuesday Morning – Rise and Restore (10:00–11:15 AM)

Getting close to full
A few spots remain. Priority goes to those registering for the full session, so if this time speaks to you, I encourage you to secure your place soon.

Tuesday Evening – Restore and Reclaim (6:00–7:15 PM)

In-person class is full
But you can still join us online! Experience the same grounding practice from the comfort of your own home. Simply click a link, settle onto your mat, and be part of the community via Zoom. Cozy, convenient, and deeply connective.

Wednesday Morning – Gentle Hatha (10:00–11:15 AM)

Space available
This beautiful mid-week morning class has room for you. If you've been looking for a gentle, grounding practice to anchor your week, this is your invitation. I'd love to see you here.

How to Join

Visit the website to book your drop-in spot. Payment accepted at the door.

Whether you're joining us in person or online, you're welcome here.

Practice of the Week

Finding the Axis

This week, I'm inviting you to try a very small practice. You don't need a yoga mat for this.

When you feel that familiar "rush" or tightness in your chest (when the emails are piling up or the noise is getting loud) try this:

1. Stop moving for just ten seconds.
2. Feel your seat in the chair or your feet on the floor.
3. Imagine your spine is the Hub of the wheel.
4. Ask yourself: "*Am I spinning right now? Or am I centered?*"

You don't have to fix it. Just noticing that you're on the Rim is often enough to bring you back toward the center.

If it helps, you might even place one hand on your heart and whisper: *"I can return to the Hub. The Still Point is always here."*

That's it. That's the whole practice.

A Closing Thought

I share this not because I've mastered the Still Point, but because I'm walking the path alongside you. We're all navigating this tension between the demands of the world and the need for a quiet heart.

If this landed with you, I'd love to hear about it. Where does the "spin" show up most in your life right now?

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura ♥

Our e-mail address is:
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